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ServiceNow University HackNow India 2026

Problem Statement: Intelligent Recruitment Engine

AEGIS

AI-Enabled Governance for Intelligent Selection

Fair hiring. No silence. Auditable AI.

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1 The Problem We Are Solving

1.1 What the problem statement asks for

The Intelligent Recruitment Engine is an AI-powered platform that automates:

- Candidate sourcing and screening
- Interview scheduling
- Feedback analysis
- Hiring recommendations
- AI-generated job descriptions

These use cases define what the platform does, but not what makes it trustworthy. The key challenge is ensuring AI decisions are explainable, auditable, and human-overridable.

AEGIS delivers both automation and trustworthy AI.

1.2 Why this problem is urgent in 2026

Three separate pressures have converged on talent acquisition, each making the others worse:

- **Application volume has broken the funnel**
  - Ashby's analysis of 100+ million applications across ~200,000 jobs found that open roles attracted 300+ applications on average.
  - Applications per hire have tripled since 2021.
  - Recruiters spend more time processing applications, increasing the risk of inconsistent screening and missed candidates.
- **Employer communication has collapsed**
  - 53% of job seekers reported being ghosted by an employer in the past year.
  - 28% of candidates said communication stopped immediately after submitting an application.
  - As hiring volumes increase, organisations need better coordination without sacrificing the candidate experience.
- **AI hiring now requires accountability**
  - Real-world cases show that automated recruitment can create serious bias and legal risks.
  - Amazon abandoned an AI recruiting system after discovering that it disadvantaged women.
  - Later AI-driven screening cases have also led to discrimination claims and regulatory attention.
  - The issue is not simply whether AI works, but whether organisations can prove that it works fairly and explain its decisions.

> **THE GAP WE ARE TARGETING**
>
> Candidates do not trust the systems judging them: multiple candidate-experience surveys report that only a minority believe AI evaluates them fairly. Regulatory requirements in jurisdictions such as the EU and New York City are raising expectations around documentation, monitoring and accountability for AI-assisted employment decisions. Many recruitment platforms automate hiring, but comparatively few expose a complete, auditable trail of how each AI decision was reached. That evidence is the product.

1.3 Who is affected, and how

Stakeholder	What goes wrong today	Consequence
Recruiter	Manually reviews hundreds of applications, many AI-generated and similar.	Qualified candidates are missed; communication is often dropped.
Hiring manager	Receives shortlists without reasoning or filtering history.	Cannot challenge or defend decisions; confidence falls.
Interview panellist	Interviews and notes are unstructured and scattered.	Scores cannot be compared; loudest opinion often wins.
Candidate	Applies without acknowledgement, outcome, or feedback.	Loses trust and gets no information to improve.
HR leadership and compliance	Cannot see funnel leaks, group-level outcomes, or maintain an AI audit trail.	Cannot provide evidence to auditors or regulators; faces compliance risk.

1.4 Root causes we are designing against

- **Speed is measured; fairness is not:**
  - Recruitment technology optimises for time-to-fill because it is easy to measure.
  - Mainstream applicant tracking systems generally do not check whether their recommendations produce different outcomes for different groups.
  - What is not measured cannot be corrected, and bias may only become visible after it has already affected candidates.
- **Matching is resume-centric in an era of AI-written resumes:**
  - Keyword matching rewards candidates who optimise their documents rather than those who are actually competent.
  - As AI-assisted applications become common, keyword matching can increasingly measure tooling and resume optimisation instead of capability.
- **The system is built for the recruiter, not for both sides:**
  - Candidate experience is often treated as a courtesy rather than a workflow obligation.
  - No accountability mechanism typically runs against employer silence.
  - When silence costs nothing, it becomes the default.

2 The Proposed Solution: AEGIS

2.1 What AEGIS is

AEGIS is a ServiceNow-native recruitment platform where every AI decision is explained, logged, and subject to human override. The name comes from aegis, meaning a shield. Its purpose is to help organisations adopt AI in hiring without absorbing unnecessary risk.

It covers the full lifecycle: requisition, JD generation, sourcing, blind screening, shortlisting, scheduling, structured feedback, recommendations, and offer closure. Architecturally, it adds a governance layer that records what each agent did, why, and whether outcomes differ measurably between groups.

What AEGIS is not

- It is not a chatbot placed on top of a job board.
- It is not keyword matching with generative AI branding attached.
- It is not a system that removes humans from hiring decisions. Every terminal decision is made by a named person.
- It is not a fairness dashboard bolted on afterwards. The audit record is written by the agents themselves, at the moment of the decision.

2.2 Four operating principles

These four rules are enforced through configuration using **agent tool scoping, ACLs, business rules, and SLAs**, not just policy statements.

- **Escalate, never adjudicate.** No agent can set a terminal candidate status. Agents write recommendations to a decision record; a human makes the final decision and records the reason.
- **Explain, never black-box.** Scores are never stored as bare numbers. Each score includes its factor breakdown, showing matched skills, missing skills, experience evidence, and the basis for the score.
- **Audit, never trust.** Every agent action writes a row to an append-only decision log. Insert is permitted; update and delete are denied to every role including the administrator, so no agent can edit its own history.
- **Respond, never ghost.** Candidate-facing stages have SLA commitments: **acknowledgement in 24 hours, screening in 5 working days, feedback in 48 hours, and final hiring decision in 10 working days (plus 2 further working days for closure communication)**. Breaches escalate instead of expiring silently.

2.3 Solution architecture

AEGIS is organised as eight layers. Each layer maps to specific ServiceNow capability; nothing is listed for the sake of listing it.

Layer	Responsibility	ServiceNow capability
1 Candidate experience	Application, status tracking, self-service answers, all outbound candidate communication	Service Portal, Virtual Agent, Notifications
2 Recruiter workspace	Pipeline view, candidate comparison, decision queue, bulk actions	Workspace Experience
3 Hiring manager & panel	Requisition raising, JD approval, interview scorecards, final decisions	Approvals, Mobile App Builder
4 AI intelligence	Seven governed agents: JD drafting, screening, scheduling, feedback synthesis, recommendation, recruiter copilot, fairness monitoring	AI Agent Studio, Now Assist (GenAI), Predictive Intelligence
5 Workflow automation	Nine end-to-end flows (F1 Requisition Approval, F2 JD Generation, F3 Application Intake, F4 Screening, F5 Shortlisting, F6 Interview Scheduling, F7 Feedback Consolidation, F8 Hiring Decision, F9 Closure) and four reusable subflows spanning requisition to closure	Flow Designer, Business Rules
6 Data & integration	Resume ingestion and parsing, skills taxonomy, panellist calendar availability	Document Intelligence, IntegrationHub (Outlook Spoke)

Layer	Responsibility	ServiceNow capability
7 Governance	Append-only decision log, guardrail enforcement, impact-ratio computation, override capture	Business Rules, ACLs, Performance Analytics
8 Analytics	Funnel health, response-time compliance, fairness indicators, recruiter workload	Performance Analytics, Dashboards

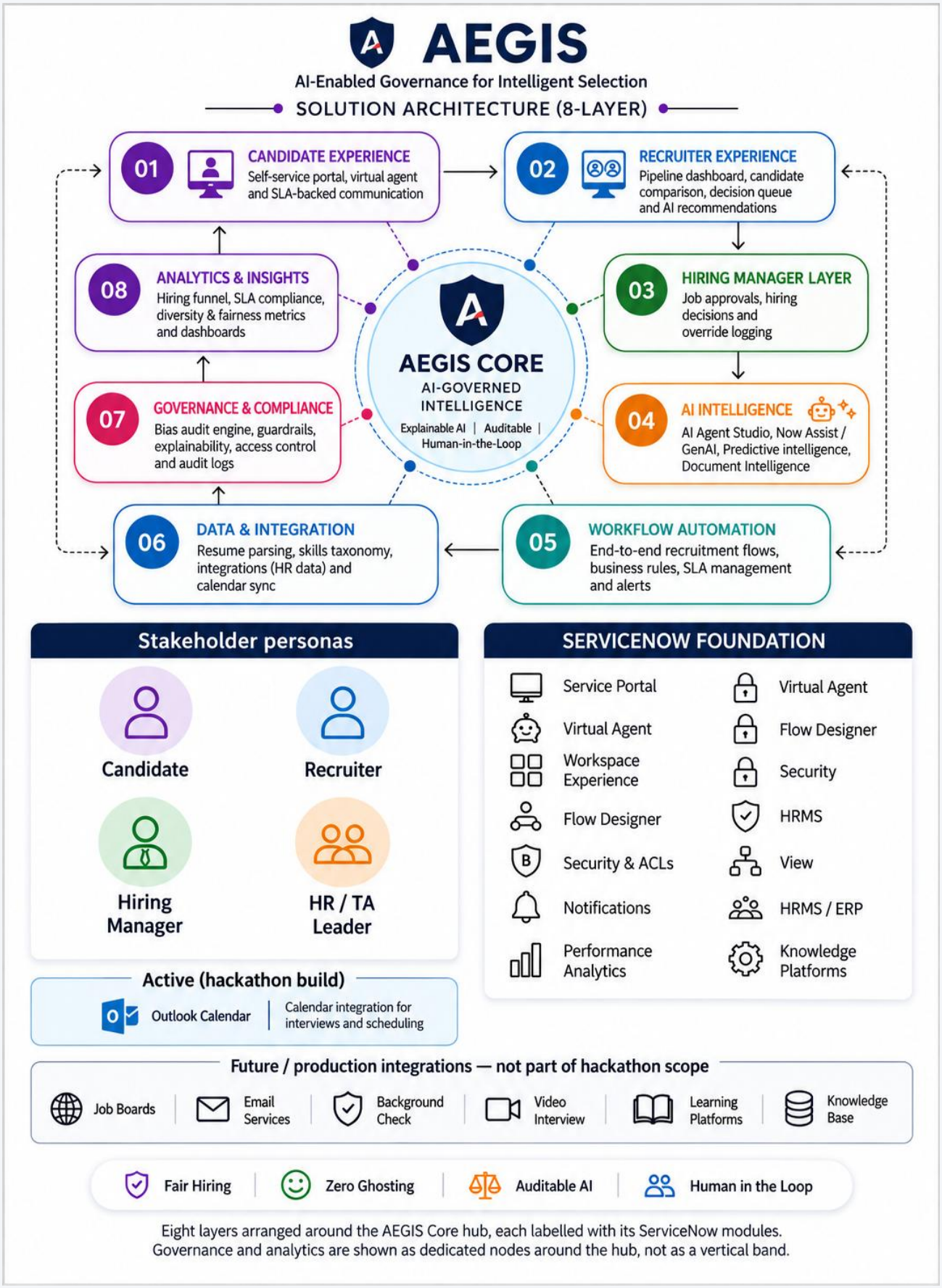


Figure 1 — Solution architecture

Eight horizontal layers, candidate experience at the top through to analytics at the base, each labelled with its ServiceNow modules. Governance and analytics are shown as dedicated nodes around the AEGIS Core hub, rather than as a vertical band.

2.4 The end-to-end recruitment journey

Stage	What happens	AI involvement	What the candidate sees
Requisition, JD and sourcing	Manager defines the role and skills. AI drafts the JD, checks biased wording, and searches the existing talent pool. Manager approves the final JD.	Drafts only; cannot publish	—
Application	Candidate applies with a resume. A **24-hour acknowledgement timer** starts.	—	Immediate confirmation with a reference number
Screening	Resume data is extracted, personal details are masked, skills are matched, and an explainable score is created.	Resume Intelligence agent, scoring across the five weighted factors while personal identifiers are masked	Status moves to under review, with an expected date
Shortlisting	**70+** proceeds, **40 to 69** goes to recruiter review, and **below 40** is closed with feedback.	Recommends; recruiter confirms	An outcome with reasons, not a form letter
Interview design and scheduling	AI creates questions based on candidate gaps and claims. Availability is checked and the interview is scheduled after recruiter confirmation.	Interview Orchestrator; optimises but does not auto-send	Preparation guidance, then a calendar invitation
Interview and feedback	Panellists score against the rubric within **48 hours**. Feedback is combined, with agreements, disagreements, and original comments preserved.	Feedback Synthesis agent, append-only	Confirmation that feedback is in progress
Decision	AI recommends **select, hold, or reject** with confidence and reasoning. Manager reviews fairness and makes the final decision.	Hiring Decision agent; cannot set status	—
Outcome	Offer workflow starts, or a closure note explains strengths, gaps, and development areas.	Drafts the closure note	A clear and respectful outcome.



Figure 2 — End-to-end recruitment flow

Requisition → JD generation → Approval → Publication → Application → Screening → three-way shortlisting → Interview design → Scheduling → Feedback → Recommendation → Human decision → Offer or closure. Each box annotated with its agent and module; human decision points marked distinctly from automated steps.

2.5 Coverage of the five required use cases

Each of the five named use cases maps to a specific component. We have added sourcing, because the stated objective includes it and a platform beginning at the application form leaves a gap.

Required use case	AEGIS component	What we add beyond the requirement
UC1 AI-generated job description	JD Architect agent with skills taxonomy and manager approval.	Inclusive-language check before publishing.
UC2 AI resume screening	Resume Intelligence agent using Document Intelligence and predictive scoring.	Personal fields masked during scoring and factor-level score explanation.
UC3 Intelligent interview scheduling	Interview Orchestrator using Outlook availability.	Candidate-specific questions and rubrics generated with the invitation.
UC4 AI feedback consolidation	Feedback Synthesis agent operating append-only over panellist submissions	Detects and highlights panel disagreements instead of only averaging scores.
UC5 Hiring recommendation agent	Hiring Decision agent recommends select, hold, or reject with reasoning.	Confidence level, fairness check, and captured override reasons.
Objective Candidate sourcing	Internal talent-pool matching and re-sourcing flow.	Previously rejected candidates are reconsidered for suitable new openings.

3 Innovation and Differentiation

3.1 How AEGIS differs from tools already on the market

We are not competing against an empty field. Workday, iCIMS, Greenhouse, HiredScore, and Eightfold already offer AI-assisted recruitment, while blind screening exists in tools such as Applied and GapJumpers. **AEGIS differentiates by combining explainability, immutable decision records, continuous fairness monitoring, and enforced candidate response commitments.**

Dimension	Typical current practice	AEGIS
Screening basis	Keyword and phrase matching against the job description.	Job-relevant skills and evidence mapped to a controlled taxonomy, with identifying fields masked during scoring.
Score transparency	Rank or recommendation with no visible reasoning.	Weighted factor breakdown stored with the score and shown to the recruiter; a plain-language summary is available to the candidate on request through the portal.
Bias handling	Separate audit, usually performed annually.	Impact ratios calculated continuously from the platform's decision log.
Decision authority	Configurable; automated rejection is common.	Agents cannot set a terminal candidate status.
Candidate communication	Acknowledgement email followed by discretionary communication.	Every stage has a timer, escalation rules, breach tracking, and future-opening reconsideration.

3.2 Seven innovation pillars

Pillars 1, 2, 4, 6 and 7 are P0 or P1 scope. Pillars 3 and 5 are the ambitious end of the design and are tiered accordingly in section 4.5.

Pillar	What it does	Why it is different
1 Explainable candidate match	Calculates fit from five visible factors: skills **(30%)**, experience **(25%)**, projects **(20%)**, certifications **(15%)**, and education **(10%)**. Each factor records what matched and what did not.	The score can be reproduced from its stored weights, making decisions defensible later.
2 Skill gap analyser	Classifies each candidate skill as **strong, moderate, missing, or transferable** against the role.	Gaps are reused for interview questions, development feedback, and internal mobility.
3 Career Twin	Builds a candidate profile from skills, projects, certifications, and interview evidence, then matches it across open and historical roles.	Goes beyond role fit by identifying **where the candidate fits best** across the organisation.
4 Personalised interview engine	Generates questions based on the **candidate's gaps and claims**, rather than only the role.	Interviewers receive the question, rubric, and reason, allowing the interview to test specific uncertainty.
5 Interview intelligence and targeted follow-up	Identifies agreement, disagreement, and remaining competency gaps across panel feedback.	Preserves original feedback and focuses follow-up on unresolved competencies.
6 RecruitAI Copilot	Answers recruiter questions using **live platform data**, such as identifying the strongest candidates.	Uses scoped, read-only access to platform data rather than acting as a general search bot.
7 FairHire governance	Monitors stage pass-through rates, AI recommendations vs. human decisions, and override frequency and direction.	Protected characteristics are never used as recommendation inputs. Threshold breaches trigger **human review** instead of automatic model adjustment.

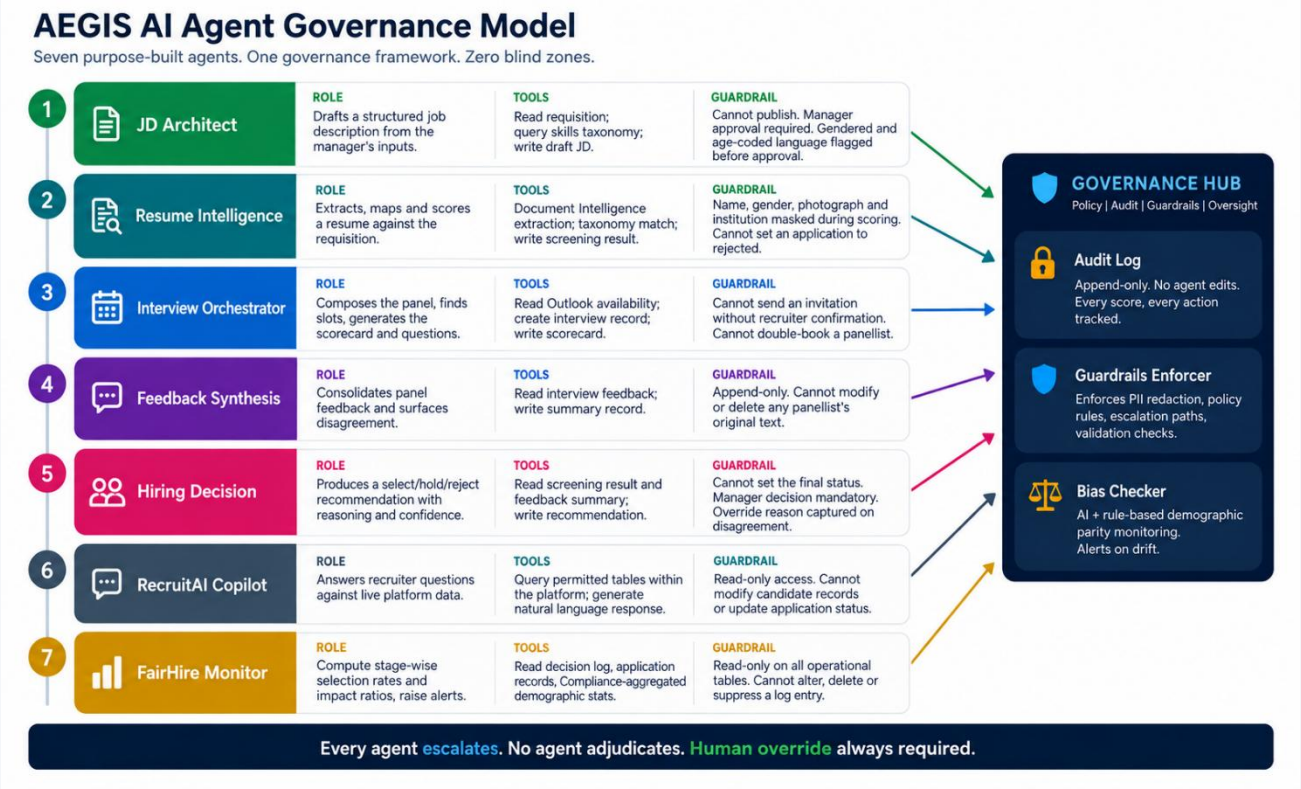


Figure 3 — AI agent governance model

Seven agent blocks around a central governance hub, each showing three bands: Role, Tools, Guardrails. The hub holds the append-only decision log, the guardrail enforcement rule and the fairness monitor. Footer band: every agent escalates, no agent adjudicates, human authority is always required.

3.3 The seven governed AI agents

Every agent is defined in AI Agent Studio under the same three-part contract. The guardrail column is the part that matters: it describes what the agent is structurally prevented from doing, enforced through tool scoping and ACLs rather than through prompt instructions.

Agent	Role	Tools available to it	Guardrail
JD Architect	Drafts a structured job description from the manager's inputs	Read requisition; query skills taxonomy; write draft JD	Cannot publish. Manager approval required. Gendered and age-coded language flagged before approval.
Resume Intelligence	Extracts, maps and scores a resume against the requisition	Document Intelligence extraction; taxonomy match; write screening result	Name, gender, photograph and institution are masked during scoring. Cannot set an application to rejected.
Interview Orchestrator	Composes the panel, finds slots, generates the scorecard and questions	Read Outlook availability; create interview record; write scorecard	Cannot send an invitation without recruiter confirmation. Cannot double-book a panellist.
Feedback Synthesis	Consolidates panel feedback and surfaces disagreement	Read interview feedback; write summary record	Append-only. Cannot modify or delete any panellist's original text.
Hiring Decision	Produces a select / hold / reject recommendation with reasoning and confidence	Read screening result and feedback summary; write recommendation	Cannot set the final status. Manager decision mandatory. Override reason captured on disagreement.
RecruitAI Copilot	Answers recruiter questions against live platform data	Query permitted tables within the caller's ACL scope; draft communications	Honours row-level ACLs. Drafts but never sends.

Agent	Role	Tools available to it	Guardrail
			Cites the source records for every answer.
FairHire Monitor	Computes stage-wise selection rates and impact ratios and raises alerts	Read decision log, application records and Compliance-produced de-identified group statistics; write audit findings	Read-only on all operational tables. Cannot alter, delete or suppress a log entry.

3.4 Bias accountability: the measurement method

AEGIS measures fairness continuously using:

- **Selection rate:** Tracks how many candidates from each group advance at every hiring stage.
- **Impact ratio:** Compares each group's selection rate with the highest-selected group.
- **Four-fifths rule:** An impact ratio below 0.80 raises a flag for review.
- **Override analysis:** Records when and why managers override AI recommendations.

Demographic attributes are held separately from the operational tables, are never available to any scoring agent, and are readable only by the compliance role. They exist to measure outcomes, never to produce them. FairHire Monitor never reads raw demographic attributes: the Compliance role aggregates them into de-identified group statistics, and FairHire consumes only that aggregate to calculate selection rates and impact ratios, preserving the access boundary.

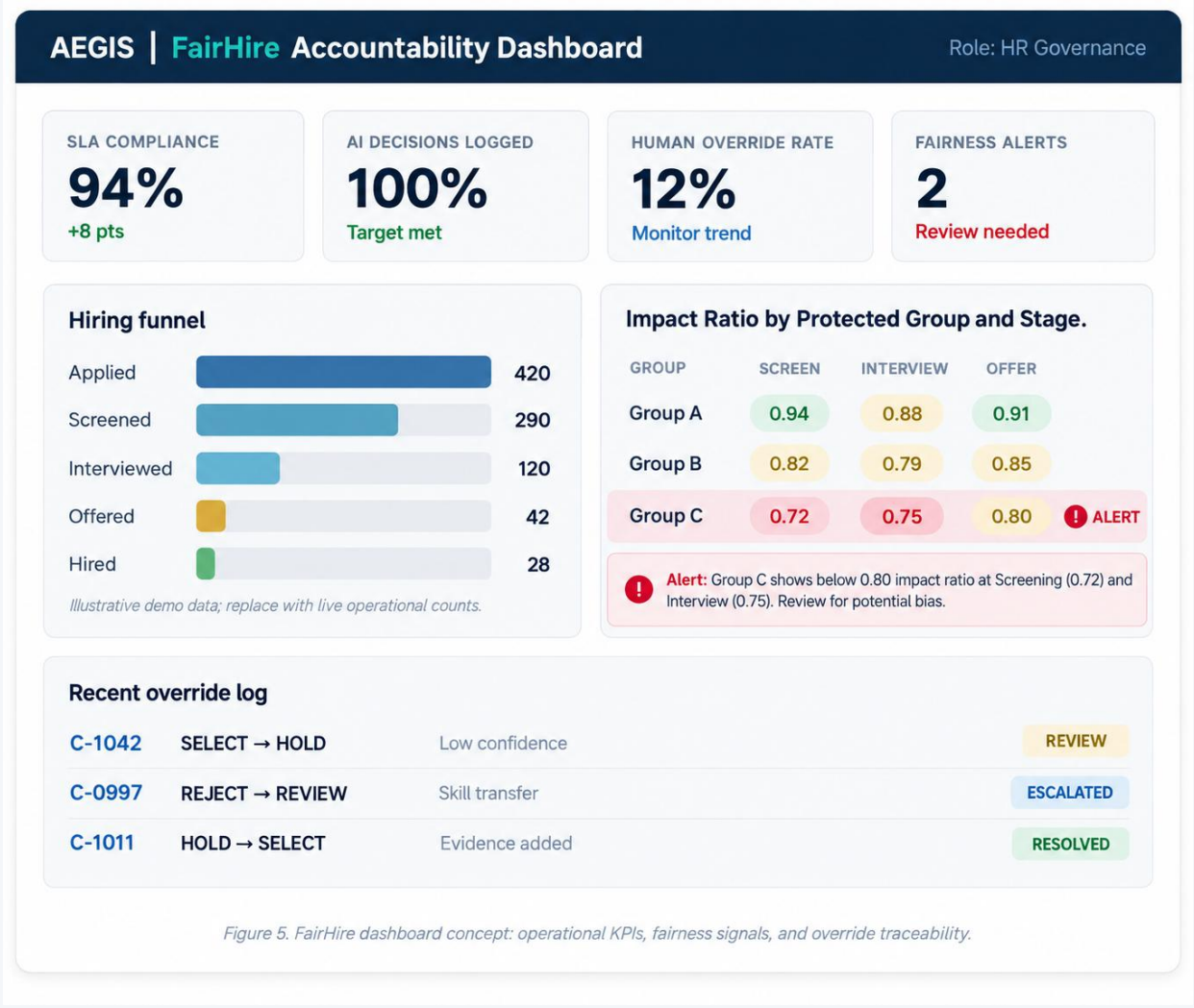


Figure 4 — FairHire accountability dashboard

Top band: funnel counts from applied to hired. Left panel: stage-wise impact ratios with the 0.80 threshold marked. Right panel: AI recommendation against final human decision, overrides highlighted. Lower band: response-time compliance, open alerts and average time in stage.

3.5 The zero-silence commitment

AEGIS applies SLA-style commitments to the hiring process. Each stage has a defined response time, a timer, and an escalation path if the deadline is missed.

Stage	Commitment	Timer starts on	On breach
Application acknowledgement	**24 hours**	Application record inserted	Notification to the assigned recruiter
Screening outcome	**5 working days**	Application enters screening	Escalation to the recruiting lead
Interview feedback	**48 hours**	Interview marked complete	Reminder to panellist, then to the hiring manager
Final decision	**10 working days**	Final interview completed	Escalation to the hiring manager and the lead
Closure communication	**2 working days**	Decision recorded	Automatic escalation; the record cannot be closed silently

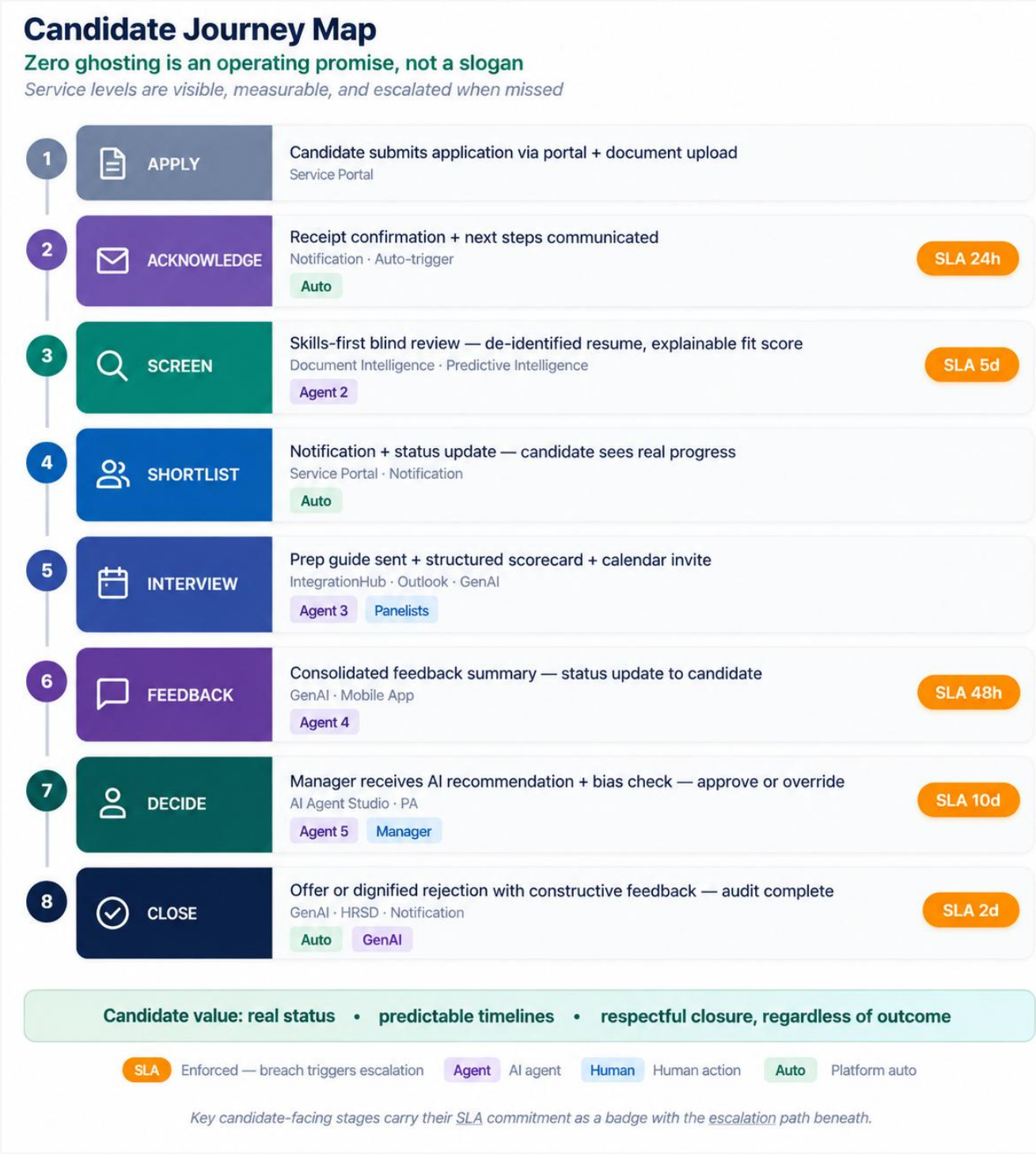


Figure 5 — Candidate journey with response commitments

Horizontal journey from Apply through Acknowledge, Screen, Shortlist, Interview, Feedback, Decision and Outcome. Key candidate-facing stages carry their SLA commitment as a badge with the escalation path beneath; candidate-visible touchpoints distinguished from internal ones.

4 Implementation Plan and Feasibility

This section focuses on feasibility. Estimates are given in person-hours against the defined team capacity so mentors can judge whether the scope is realistic within the available time.

4.1 Technical stack

Component	ServiceNow module or technology	What it delivers in AEGIS
Application platform	App Engine Studio (scoped application), HR Service Delivery	Custom tables, roles, ACLs, business rules, requisition lifecycle and case-handling patterns
Resume ingestion	Document Intelligence	Extraction of text and structured fields from uploaded resumes
Agent framework	AI Agent Studio	Seven agents with scoped roles, tools and guardrails
Generative capability	Now Assist / GenAI	JD drafting, question generation, feedback synthesis, closure notes
Scoring	Predictive Intelligence	Similarity and classification behind the fit score
Automation	Flow Designer, Business Rules	Nine flows and four subflows; guardrail and audit enforcement
Response enforcement	SLA Management	Candidate response commitments and escalation
Integration	IntegrationHub — Outlook Spoke	Panellist availability and calendar invitations
Interfaces	Service Portal and Virtual Agent; Workspace Experience; Mobile App Builder	Candidate application and status tracking; recruiter pipeline and decision queue; panellist scorecard submission from a phone
Reporting	Performance Analytics, Dashboards	Funnel, response compliance and the FairHire view

The only third-party dependency is Microsoft Outlook 365, via the IntegrationHub Outlook Spoke. Job-board and LinkedIn publication are designed for but deferred beyond the hackathon: neither is needed to demonstrate the platform, and both add credential dependencies we cannot guarantee on a developer instance. The other systems shown in Figure 1's integrations band — job boards, background check, video interview, HRMS/ERP and learning platforms — are future/production integrations outside the hackathon build; none is a dependency of the P0–P5 scope described here.

4.2 Data model and security roles

Nine operational tables in one scoped application, plus one access-restricted demographic table kept outside the operational model. The count is deliberately small: each earns its place by owning a distinct lifecycle.

Table	Owns
Job Requisition	Role, level, skills required, approval state
Job Description	JD versions, language-check result, approval trail
Candidate	Profile, contact, consent flags, Career Twin attributes (P2, optional)
Application	Candidate-to-requisition link, stage, SLA state
Screening Result	Fit score, factor breakdown, generated explanation
Interview	Panel, schedule, question set, outcome
Interview Feedback	Per-panellist rubric scores and verbatim comments
Hiring Decision	AI recommendation, human decision, override reason
AI Decision Log	Every agent action, its input summary and its output

Security model: Six roles control access: Recruiter, Hiring Manager, Interview Panellist, Candidate, Compliance Auditor, and Application Administrator.

Only the Compliance Auditor can read demographic attributes. No role, including the Application Administrator, can update or delete the AI Decision Log — which records every governed agent action (drafts and recommendations included, not only terminal decisions). This ensures the audit trail remains meaningful and tamper-resistant. Demographic attributes live in a tenth, access-restricted structure — a Protected Demographic Store, deliberately kept separate from the nine operational tables above and scoped so only the Compliance Auditor role can read it directly.

4.3 Build window and phase plan

Phase	Window	Calendar days	Deliverables	Exit criteria
P0 Foundation	15 – 17 Sep	3	Scoped application, nine tables, six roles and ACLs, skills taxonomy loaded, HRSD configuration	A requisition can be raised and routed for approval end to end
P1 Workflow core	17 – 20 Sep	4	Nine flows, four subflows, SLA definitions, notification framework, guardrail business rules	An application moves through every stage manually with timers running
P2 AI layer	19 – 24 Sep	6	Seven agents, Document Intelligence configuration, GenAI prompts, Predictive Intelligence model, decision log wiring	A resume is screened and explained without human intervention
P3 Experience layer	22 – 28 Sep	7	Candidate portal, recruiter workspace, mobile scorecard, Virtual Agent topics, Outlook integration	A candidate completes an application and a panellist submits feedback on a phone
P4 Analytics & governance	26 – 30 Sep	5	Performance Analytics dashboards, FairHire impact-ratio computation, override reporting, demonstration dataset	The FairHire dashboard produces a live impact ratio from seeded data
Code freeze	1 Oct	1	No new functionality after this point	P0 scope complete and demonstrable
P5 Stabilisation	2 – 6 Oct	5	End-to-end test passes, defect fixes, architecture documentation, ten-minute video, submission package	Two clean rehearsal runs of the full demonstration

4.4 Effort and capacity model

Workstream	Estimated effort	Share	Primary owner
Foundation: scoped app, data model, roles, ACLs	**55 hours**	10%	Kaustubh
Workflow automation: flows, subflows, SLAs, notifications	**105 hours**	19%	Chaitanya
AI layer: seven agents, Document Intelligence, GenAI, PI model	**150 hours**	27%	Rakesh
Experience layer: portal, workspace, mobile, Virtual Agent	**130 hours**	23%	Deepthi
Analytics and governance: dashboards, FairHire, audit views	**65 hours**	12%	Mahesh
Integration: Outlook Spoke and calendar handling	**30 hours**	5%	Chaitanya & Mahesh
Contingency held in reserve	**25 hours**	4%	All
Total available before code freeze	**560 hours**	**100%**	

4.5 Scope tiers and what we will not build

Every feature is tiered before the build starts, so descoping under pressure is a decision already made rather than a panic on 30 September.

Tier	Contents	Commitment
P0 Must ship	Requisition and JD generation with approval; portal application; Document Intelligence screening with explainable fit score; three-way shortlisting; Outlook scheduling; mobile scorecard and feedback capture; AI recommendation with mandatory human decision; append-only decision log; funnel dashboard	This is the demonstration. If nothing else ships, this does.
P1 Strongly intended	Skill gap analyser; candidate-specific question generation; RecruitAI Copilot; FairHire impact-ratio dashboard; SLA enforcement with escalation; Virtual Agent topics	Expected to ship. These carry the innovation story.
P2 If the schedule allows	Career Twin and cross-requisition matching; targeted follow-up interview agent; talent-pool re-matching of prior applicants; pipeline forecasting	Built only after P0 and P1 are stable.
Out of scope	External job-board and LinkedIn publication; offer-letter generation and e-signature; background verification; payroll or onboarding handover; multi-language interface	Designed for, deliberately not built. Named here so the boundary is explicit.

4.6 Dependencies, risks and mitigations

The honest risk in this project is platform availability, not team capability. Several of the capabilities AEGIS depends on are licensed features whose presence on a developer instance we cannot confirm until access is granted on 10 September. Each has a defined fallback that preserves the architecture even if the implementation changes.

4.7 Feasibility assessment

- **Skills and modules.** All five members hold CSA and CAD, and every primary individual workstream has a named second (Integration and Contingency are jointly owned, so a single second does not apply to them). App Engine, HRSD, Flow Designer, Service Portal, Workspace, Virtual Agent, Mobile App Builder and Performance Analytics are standard; AI Agent Studio, Now Assist, Document Intelligence and Predictive Intelligence are licence-dependent and each has a fallback above.
- **Credibility without live AI.** Under every fallback the flows, the explanation format, the decision log and the FairHire computation remain intact. What changes is how the inference is produced, not what the platform does with it.
- **Slack and failure mode.** P0 needs roughly 340 of the 560 available hours. New functionality stops at code freeze, five days before submission; only bug fixes and stabilisation continue afterward. The realistic failure mode is attempting P2 features before P0 is stable, which the tier discipline in section 4.5 exists to prevent.

5 Impact and Measurable Outcomes

Every figure below is a projection with its derivation stated. We have not claimed improvements to parts of the hiring cycle the platform does not control — notice periods, salary negotiation and candidate decision time are excluded from every estimate.

5.1 Baselines, targets and how each is derived

Measure	Baseline	Target	How the target is derived
Recruiter time per application	12 – 20 minutes of manual reading	3 – 4 minutes reviewing a prepared brief	Extraction and scoring are machine work. The recruiter reviews a factor breakdown and evidence rather than an unstructured document. The saving is in reading time, not in judgement time.
Time to fill	39 days median for non-executive roles (SHRM, 2026)	Reduction of 8 – 12 days	Only the stages AEGIS controls are counted: screening turnaround, scheduling latency and feedback collection. Sourcing lead time, notice periods and negotiation are excluded.
Candidates receiving a definite outcome	53% report being ghosted; 28% get no response after applying	100% receive a terminal status within 12 working days of the final interview (10 working days to decision, plus 2 further working days for closure communication)	This is a workflow guarantee, not a behavioural prediction. A record cannot be closed without a communication step, and every timer escalates on breach.
Evaluation consistency	Unstructured interviews, scores not comparable across panellists	All interviews scored against a shared rubric	Structured interviewing has substantially higher predictive validity than unstructured (Schmidt & Hunter, 1998). The platform makes the structured path the default rather than the disciplined exception.
AI decisions explained and logged	Typically neither exposed nor recorded	100% of both	A score record cannot be written without its factor breakdown, and every agent writes to the append-only log as part of its action. Both are data model constraints rather than reporting features.
Fairness measurement	Annual external audit, where performed at all	Impact ratio computed per stage, continuously	Selection rates and impact ratios are derived from the platform's own records using the four-fifths threshold described in section 3.4.

5.2 How we will demonstrate the numbers

A claim that cannot be shown in a ten-minute video is not worth making. The demonstration dataset exists to make each mechanism visible.

What we show	How we show it
Explainability and the audit trail are structural	Attempt to save a screening result without its factor breakdown: the business rule rejects the insert. Attempt to modify a decision log entry as the administrator role: the ACL denies the update.
Fairness monitoring actually fires	The demonstration set of roughly 120 synthetic candidate profiles across 8 requisitions includes a deliberately skewed subset. The FairHire dashboard drops below the 0.80 impact-ratio threshold and raises the alert on screen.
Response commitments are enforced	An application is left unactioned past its acknowledgement window; the timer breaches and the escalation appears in the recruiter's manager's queue.
Humans hold the authority	The Hiring Decision agent recommends reject. The manager selects hold, and the form blocks the save until an override reason is entered. Both the recommendation and the override appear in the log.
Screening is genuinely blind	The same resume is submitted twice with different names and photographs; extracted skills and fit score are identical.

5.3 Real-world applicability and path to production

AEGIS is a scoped application on standard platform capability, so the path from hackathon artefact to deployable product is hardening rather than rewriting. At LTIMindtree's scale, the components that scale best — screening throughput, scheduling coordination and response-time enforcement — are exactly those consuming the most recruiter time. For clients already running HRSD, adoption needs no new platform purchase, and the governance layer is the differentiator in an enterprise conversation because it answers the question a client's legal team asks first.

The regulatory timing is favourable. With the EU AI Act's high-risk obligations in force since 2 August 2026 and Local Law 144 entering stricter enforcement, producing an audit trail on demand is shifting from differentiator toward requirement — and a platform generating that evidence as a by-product of normal operation is far cheaper to run than one commissioning it annually. The same pattern transfers with little change to university admissions, scholarship allocation and public-sector recruitment.

6 Team Roles, Expertise and Coordination

Five members, each owning a workstream end to end and acting as named second on one other. Kaustubh Thallam leads the team and holds final say on architecture and scope.

Member	Workstream owned	Modules	Second on
Kaustubh Thallam	Solution architecture, data model, security model, scope arbitration	App Engine Studio, HRSD, ACLs	AI layer
Chaitanya Saradhi Gadamsetty	Workflow automation, SLA enforcement, notifications, Outlook integration	Flow Designer, Business Rules, SLA Management, IntegrationHub	Foundation
Rakesh Sankar Pydi	Agent design and guardrails, resume extraction, prompt engineering, scoring model	AI Agent Studio, Now Assist, Document Intelligence, Predictive Intelligence	Workflow automation

Member	Workstream owned	Modules	Second on
Deepthi Parisigani	Candidate portal, recruiter workspace, mobile scorecard, Virtual Agent	Service Portal, Workspace Experience, Mobile App Builder, Virtual Agent	Analytics
Mahesh Juvvaldinne	Dashboards, FairHire computation, demonstration data, test execution, documentation and video	Performance Analytics, Dashboards	Experience layer

How we will work

- **Daily fifteen-minute stand-up.** Progress, blockers and today's intent. Anything blocked for more than a day is escalated to the team lead that evening.
- **Update sets reviewed daily.** All configuration is captured in named update sets and reviewed by the team lead before merge, so no work sits only on one person's session.
- **Weekly scope checkpoint and two rehearsals.** Every Sunday we confirm the tier status of each feature; a P1 feature not started by 26 September is dropped rather than carried. The demonstration is rehearsed end to end on 3 October and again on 5 October, with defects from the first run fixed in between.

7 References

ServiceNow platform documentation

Product documentation at docs.servicenow.com for HR Service Delivery, AI Agent Studio, Now Assist, Document Intelligence, Predictive Intelligence, Flow Designer, Service Portal, Workspace Experience, Virtual Agent, Mobile App Builder, IntegrationHub and Performance Analytics.

Regulation and case law

- New York City Local Law 144 of 2021, in force since 5 July 2023: an independent bias audit within the preceding twelve months, public posting of a summary, and ten business days' notice to candidates before an automated employment decision tool is used. Regulation (EU) 2024/1689 (the EU AI Act): employment, worker management and access to self-employment are listed as high-risk under Annex III, with high-risk obligations effective 2 August 2026.

- Mobley v. Workday, Inc., Case No. 3:23-cv-00770-RFL, N.D. Cal. Collective action on ADEA claims preliminarily certified May 2025; notice authorised 17 February 2026; core discrimination claims permitted to proceed 22 June 2026. Adverse-impact testing follows the EEOC Uniform Guidelines on Employee Selection Procedures (four-fifths rule).

Industry evidence and benchmarks

- Dastin, J. (2018). Amazon scraps secret AI recruiting tool that showed bias against women. Reuters, 10 October 2018.

- iHire candidate experience survey (2026): 53 percent of job seekers ghosted within the past year, against 48 percent in 2025 and 38 percent in 2024; 28 percent ghosted after application and 20 percent after a first interview. Reported alongside Criteria Corporation data via Fortune, March 2026.

- Ashby (May 2026), analysis of over 100 million applications across approximately 200,000 postings: 300 or more applications per open role on average, with the applications-per-hire ratio tripling since 2021. Greenhouse platform data, 2026: 254 applicants per job and a 412 percent increase in applications per recruiter. LinkedIn hiring trends, 2025–2026: approximately 11,000 applications submitted per minute, up 45 percent year on year.

- Society for Human Resource Management benchmarking: median time to fill of 39 days for non-executive roles in 2026, down from 44 days in 2025; average non-executive cost per hire approximately US$5,475 (2025). Schmidt, F. L., & Hunter, J. E. (1998), The validity and utility of selection methods in personnel psychology, Psychological Bulletin, 124(2), 262–274.